CASCADIA ANALYTICS

Cardinal Infrastructure Group Inc.

Equity Research Note | CDNL | 22 OCTOBER 2026

Southeast Infrastructure Roll-Up

Cardinal Infrastructure screens as a Buy with a $52.70 blended target, 282% above the current price.

Analyst: Justin Wen

REFERENCE PRICE	BLENDED TARGET	BLENDED UPSIDE	
$13.80	$52.70	+282%	BUY

Investment Thesis

Southeast Infrastructure Roll-Up. Full-service civil and site development provider using a self-performing model in high-growth SE markets. Q2 revenue of $226.9M was up 114% YoY, driven by scale and the ALGC acquisition [8-K]. Margins Are the Whole Story. Adj EBITDA margin fell to 12.4% from 18.6% and GAAP gross margin printed 10.8% [8-K]. Management lifted the FY2026 revenue guide to $880-900M while cutting the margin guide to 16-18% from the 20%+ set in Q1, and EPS of $0.26 missed consensus of about $0.47. The

- Southeast Infrastructure Roll-Up
- Margins Are the Whole Story
- 269% Upside If Execution Holds

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The latest print

Margins Are the Whole Story. Adj EBITDA margin fell to 12.4% from 18.6% and GAAP gross margin printed 10.8%. Management lifted the FY2026 revenue guide to $880-900M while cutting the margin guide to 16-18% from the 20%+ set in Q1, and EPS of $0.26 missed consensus of about $0.47. The market prices -20.2% implied revenue CAGR, below the 6.0% bear case.

269% Upside If Execution Holds. At $13.80, DCF base $50.90 implies 269% upside and forward P/E is 4.5x. Distressed pricing for a growing business, but thin cash flow conversion is the sword of Damocles until margins recover. The discount opened on credibility, not demand: the June secondary offering sold 4.6M shares at $73.00 weeks before the margin guide came down, and the selling has continued through two acquisition announcements since.

$226.9M	12.4%	$4.7M	$880-900M	16% to 18%	$0.26
REVENUE (Q2 '26)	ADJ EBITDA MARGIN (Q2 '26)	NET INCOME (Q2 '26)	FY2026 REVENUE GUIDE (LIFTED)	FY2026 EBITDA MARGIN GUIDE (CUT)	EPS (Q2 '26)

Key metrics in detail

METRIC	LATEST	VS YEAR AGO	TREND
Revenue (Q2 '26)	$226.9M	+114%	Up
Adj EBITDA Margin (Q2 '26)	12.4%	-620 bps (18.6% PY)	Down
Net Income (Q2 '26)	$4.7M	-35%	Down
FY2026 Revenue Guide (lifted)	$880-900M	Raised from $665-678M	Up
FY2026 EBITDA Margin Guide (cut)	16% to 18%	Cut from 20%+ set in Q1	Down
EPS (Q2 '26)	$0.26	vs consensus about $0.47	Down
Backlog (Q2 '26)	$866M	+35% YoY, vs +60% in Q1	Up
Hughes Brothers Deal (pending)	$357.5M	60% cash / 40% stock; close expected Q4 2026	Flat
Market Cap	$313M	-84% from 52w high $96.40	Down
Forward P/E	4.5x	vs trailing 17.2x	Down

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The moat

FY2026 revenue guide lifted to $880-900M, including the ALGC acquisition contribution

The growth engine

Self-performing civil and site development model across high-growth Southeast markets

Three scenarios make the valuation range explicit

Three scenarios frame the range; the blended target balances the three outcomes.

SCENARIO	2026-30 CAGR	2030 REVENUE	2030 EBIT MARGIN	TARGET	UPSIDE
Bear	6.0%	$1.11B	11.8%	**$40.00**	+190%
Base	12.0%	$1.40B	12.3%	**$50.90**	+269%
Bull	18.0%	$1.74B	13.8%	**$69.00**	+400%

Bear: downside case at $40.00 (+190%).

Base: central case at $50.90 (+269%).

Bull: upside case at $69.00 (+400%).

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The probability-blended target implies 282% upside

The blended target implies +282% from the $13.80 reference price, balancing the Bear, Base and Bull outcomes in the scenario matrix.

$52.70
BLENDED TARGET

The valuation uses a multi-year discounted cash flow framework across three scenarios. Discount rates are market-implied and updated from live market inputs. The scenario matrix above states what each scenario assumes in growth and margin terms and what it produces: horizon revenue, enterprise value, equity value and the per-share target.

We judge a scenario by whether its growth and margin posture is supported by the filed record and the company's own guidance, and we disclose below how much of each scenario's value sits in the terminal year, because that share is where the valuation risk concentrates.

Reference price	**$13.80**
Bear target	**$40.00**
Base target	**$50.90**
Bull target	**$69.00**
Blended target	**$52.70**
Terminal value share of Base enterprise value	**92.9%**

BUY | $52.70 BLENDED TARGET | WEN

The reverse DCF: what the market prices in

The market-implied revenue CAGR is -20.2%, below Bear case (6%) — pessimistic.

Reverse DCF sensitivity

Implied enterprise value and share price at each five-year revenue CAGR. The highlighted row sits nearest the market-implied CAGR.

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CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price	CAGR	Implied EV	Implied price
-35%	$0.3B	$8.27	-15%	$0.6B	$16.41	+5%	$1.4B	$32.19
-34%	$0.3B	$8.55	-14%	$0.7B	$16.98	+6%	$1.4B	$33.24
-33%	$0.3B	$8.83	-13%	$0.7B	$17.58	+7%	$1.5B	$34.33
-32%	$0.3B	$9.13	-12%	$0.7B	$18.20	+8%	$1.5B	$35.44
-31%	$0.3B	$9.45	-11%	$0.8B	$18.84	+9%	$1.6B	$36.59
-30%	$0.3B	$9.77	-10%	$0.8B	$19.50	+10%	$1.7B	$37.76
-29%	$0.3B	$10.11	-9%	$0.8B	$20.18	+11%	$1.7B	$38.97
-28%	$0.4B	$10.46	-8%	$0.8B	$20.88	+12%	$1.8B	$40.21
-27%	$0.4B	$10.82	-7%	$0.9B	$21.60	+13%	$1.8B	$41.48
-26%	$0.4B	$11.20	-6%	$0.9B	$22.35	+14%	$1.9B	$42.79
-25%	$0.4B	$11.59	-5%	$1.0B	$23.12	+15%	$2.0B	$44.13
-24%	$0.4B	$12.00	-4%	$1.0B	$23.91	+16%	$2.0B	$45.50
-23%	$0.4B	$12.42	-3%	$1.0B	$24.73	+17%	$2.1B	$46.91
-22%	$0.5B	$12.86	-2%	$1.1B	$25.57	+18%	$2.2B	$48.35
-21%	$0.5B	$13.32	-1%	$1.1B	$26.43	+19%	$2.2B	$49.83
-20%	**$0.5B**	**$13.79**	+0%	$1.2B	$27.33	+20%	$2.3B	$51.34
-19%	$0.5B	$14.28	+1%	$1.2B	$28.24	+21%	$2.4B	$52.90
-18%	$0.6B	$14.78	+2%	$1.2B	$29.19	+22%	$2.4B	$54.49
-17%	$0.6B	$15.31	+3%	$1.3B	$30.16	+23%	$2.5B	$56.12
-16%	$0.6B	$15.85	+4%	$1.3B	$31.16			

Balance sheet and share count reconciliation

Enterprise value converts to equity value after net debt, and targets divide by diluted shares.

SCENARIO	ENTERPRISE VALUE	PLUS: NET CASH	EQUITY VALUE	TARGET
Bear	$1.76B	$142M	$1.90B	**$40.00**
Base	$2.28B	$142M	$2.42B	**$50.90**
Bull	$3.14B	$142M	$3.28B	**$69.00**

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Terminal value share

We disclose how much of each scenario value sits in the terminal year. Terminal value is 92.9% of Base enterprise value (Bear 91.3%, Bull 95.0%). A high terminal share means the target rests primarily on the terminal-year economics in the scenario matrix rather than on the explicit forecast years, and we weigh it accordingly in the investment view.

Fair value across scenarios

Model fair value by year under each scenario, on the same paths the ticker page chart draws.

SCENARIO	2026	2026	2027	2028	2029	2030
Bear	$40.00	$42.37	$47.02	$49.20	$51.18	$52.96
Base	$50.90	$53.91	$59.15	$62.21	$65.09	$67.86
Bull	$69.00	$73.05	$79.50	$84.11	$88.66	$93.19

Methodology note. Our valuation framework discounts scenario cash flows at market-implied discount rates updated from live market inputs. The $52.70 headline target is the blended outcome of the Bear, Base and Bull scenarios in the matrix above.

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The franchise deep dive

FY2026 revenue guide lifted to $880-900M, including the ALGC acquisition contribution

Self-performing civil and site development model across high-growth Southeast markets

The FY2026 adjusted EBITDA margin guide was cut from the prior 20%+ target; Q2 printed a 12.4% adjusted EBITDA margin

Hughes Brothers, if it closes in Q4 2026, adds $220M of TTM revenue at a 25.0% adjusted EBITDA margin and about $350M of backlog in Central Florida

Seven insiders bought 221,597 shares for about $8.5M in the open market on August 14-17, 2026, led by CEO Jeremy Spivey with 83,350 shares

Revenue and margin trend

METRIC	2024	2025	TTM	Q2 '26	FY2026E
Revenue	n/a	$0.46B	$0.67B	$0.23B	$880-900M
Gross Margin	n/a	21.1%	n/a	n/a	n/a
Op Margin	n/a	8.8%	7.0%	n/a	n/a

Valuation cross-check

Fwd P/E 4.5x

DCF Base $50.90

NTM EV/EBITDA 3.5x

269% upside to the base case. But the reverse DCF implies -20.2% revenue CAGR: the market is pricing contraction, so the discount may be earned, not gifted.

Heavy civil/infrastructure peers trade mid-single-digit EV/EBITDA

CDNL screens at or below peer multiples despite a faster revenue trajectory. Peers are larger, less leveraged and more diversified, which justifies some discount.

Stock $13.80 vs 52w high $96.40

Down roughly 84% from the high as margin compression and acquisition digestion reset expectations. Limited public history makes historical comparison thin.

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What to monitor

Nov 2026. Q3 2026 Earnings (Two-Sided): Adj EBITDA margin was 12.4% in Q2 vs 18.6% a year ago. Recovery toward the 20% target is the entire bull case test.

2026. ALGC Integration (Two-Sided): Acquisition closed Feb 18, 2026 and drives the $880-900M revenue guide. Execution and margin accretion are unproven.

2026-2027. Southeast Infrastructure Cycle (Positive): Civil and site development demand across high-growth SE markets supports backlog, but is cyclical and weather-exposed.

Q4 2026. Hughes Brothers Close (Two-Sided): The $357.5M deal adds a Central Florida platform and 5,255,420 shares at a $27.21 contractual price, plus an earnout of up to $162.5M. HSR clearance is pending.

2026-2027. Securities Litigation (Negative): Three firms have announced investigations tied to the June secondary offering and the margin disclosures. A filed complaint, or a quiet close to the inquiries, moves the overhang either way.

Financial summary: income statement

YEAR	REVENUE	GROSS PROFIT	OPERATING INCOME	EBITDA
2025	$456M	$96M	$40M	$72M

Balance sheet

YEAR	TOTAL ASSETS	TOTAL LIABILITIES	TOTAL EQUITY	CASH
2025	$395M	$255M	$58M	$97M

Cash flow

YEAR	OPERATING CF	CAPEX	FINANCING CF	FREE CF
2025	$38M	$-44M	$140M	$-6M

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Agency risk score 67 of 100: balanced, typical corporate alignment

The score follows the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model: insider ownership up to 40 points, open-market Form 4 flow over the trailing six months up to 30, and pay-for-performance up to 30. Insiders hold 8.76% of shares outstanding. Form 4 filings over the trailing six months show $9.57M of open-market purchases against $0 of sales, a net flow of $9.57M. One-year total shareholder return is -41.3% against CEO total pay of $450.0K (Mr. Jeremy Spivey), which the model scores as SUB-OPTIMAL ALIGNMENT.

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AGENCY RISK SCORE, OF 100

The three components

COMPONENT	SCORE	WHAT THE SITE SHOWS
Insider Ownership (Skin in the Game)	25 / 40	8.76% of shares held by insiders
Form 4 Flow (Conviction Flow)	30 / 30	Buys $9.57M (8) vs sales $0 (0), net $9.57M, trailing six months
Pay-for-Performance	12 / 30	SUB-OPTIMAL ALIGNMENT: Negative Shareholder Returns vs Static Executive Comp. 1Y TSR -41.3%; Mr. Jeremy Spivey, CEO & Chairman, total pay $450.0K
Agency Risk Score	**67 / 100**	Regime: BALANCED / TYPICAL CORPORATE

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Recent Form 4 filings

DATE	FILER	RELATION	TYPE	SHARES	VALUE
2026-08-17	Wimmer Richard Bennett	Director	BUY	7,500	$293.5K
2026-08-14	Zelman Ivy	Director	BUY	12,647	$500.9K
2026-08-14	Lee Richard Melvin Jr.	Director	BUY	34,000	$1.25M
2026-08-14	Spivey Jeremy Simmons	Chief Executive Officer	BUY	83,350	$3.20M
2026-08-14	Rowe Michael Bruce Jr.	Chief Financial Officer	BUY	7,000	$255.7K
2026-08-14	Wood Benjamin A.	Chief Operating Officer	BUY	25,700	$1.01M
2026-08-14	Wood Anthony Leon Jr	Director	BUY	51,400	$2.02M
2026-05-27	Wood Benjamin A.	Chief Operating Officer	BUY	20,000	$1.03M

SEC proxy audit, DEF 14A filed 2026-04-24

Alignment grade D. COMPENSATION DATA EXCLUDED FROM EXCERPT. Jeremy Spivey, fiscal 2025 vs fiscal 2024; total compensation change year on year: N/A.

BASE SALARY	STOCK AWARDS	NON-EQUITY INCENTIVE	OTHER COMPENSATION
N/A	N/A	N/A	N/A

The excerpt terminates prior to page 26, omitting the Summary Compensation Table and CD&A disclosures necessary to quantify executive pay. However, disclosures reveal significant insider liquidity surrounding the December 2025 IPO, including an $83.3 million unit redemption to CEO Jeremy Spivey alongside ongoing related-party lease arrangements. Because the IPO closed on December 9, 2025, the Compensation Committee held zero formal meetings during fiscal 2025, leaving governance oversight newly nascent.

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Proxy audit source: SEC EDGAR DEF 14A, audited 2026-10-18 by the weekly proxy pipeline. Filing: https://www.sec.gov/Archives/edgar/data/2079999/000119312526177393/cdnl-20260424.htm

Methodology. This module reuses the website's Executive Alignment & Agency Risk model unchanged. Scores of 75 and above band as founder-mode, high conviction; 45 to 74 as balanced, typical corporate; below 45 as high agency risk. Inputs are the same feeds behind the site model (Yahoo Finance insider holdings, Form 4 transactions and executive compensation) plus the SEC DEF 14A CD&A audit from the weekly proxy pipeline. Computed 24 October 2026 for this note.

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The bear case

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Margin Collapse

Adjusted EBITDA margin fell to 12.4% in Q2 from 18.6% a year ago and GAAP gross margin printed 10.8%, against a full-year margin guide management cut to 16-18% from 20%+ in the same release that raised revenue guidance. The company's own account assigns the pressure to subcontracted labor and equipment rental costs in developing markets, a mix shift toward larger commercial and industrial work, accelerated G&A spending, and Southeast weather. The self-performing cost advantage the equity story rests on did not show up in the quarter.

Leverage on a Small Base

The $142M net cash position is the June 30, 2026 filed balance sheet: $197M of debt against $339M of cash. About $88.9M went out for Allied Paving on October 1, and the Hughes Brothers cash portion of $214.5M is funded from cash on hand and credit facility borrowings, with a $250M delayed-draw term loan added in September. The forward balance sheet carries debt the June anchor does not show.

Cyclical + Integration Risk

Civil and site development is cyclical, weather-exposed, and concentrated in the Southeast. Integration evidence is mixed: Q1 commentary called ALGC a strong contributor from day one, while the Q2 10-Q cut the acquired ALGC backlog intangible by $5.1M on revised backlog revenue and completion schedules. Plaintiff firms now allege scalability problems at ALGC were not disclosed; the company has not reported them.

Hughes Brothers Dilution and Earnout

The amended Hughes Brothers agreement pays $357.5M at 60% cash and 40% stock: 5,255,420 shares priced at the $27.21 signing VWAP while the market trades near $13.80. The earnout adds up to $162.5M, payable 60% in cash and 40% in stock, on Hughes adjusted EBITDA for the year to June 30, 2027, and up to 2,388,827 further shares at the maximum. Closing is expected in Q4 2026 subject to HSR clearance, so none of this is in the current share count or balance sheet, and all of it lands at once.

Litigation Overhang

Hagens Berman (September 10), Lowey Dannenberg (September 17) and Scott+Scott (October 14) have announced investigations into potential federal securities law violations, centered on the June 24 secondary offering of 4.6M shares at $73.00 and on whether project cost pressures were disclosed while margin guidance stood above 20%. No finding has been made against the company; the overhang itself keeps institutional buyers sidelined and raises the cost of the next capital raise.

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Backlog Deceleration

Backlog reached a record $866M at June 30, but growth slowed to +35% year over year from +60% at March 31, and the 10-Q expects $734M to $812M of it to convert within twelve months. For a company valued on hyper-growth, a halving of backlog growth makes new awards lumpier and removes the forward cover the multiple rested on.

The strengths

Operating Quality

Small-cap civil/infrastructure contractor with thin moat (competitive bidding), 21% gross and 8.8% operating margins on FY2025, and a net cash position of $142M at June 30, 2026. Q2 2026 gross margin printed 10.8% as subcontracted labor and equipment rentals replaced self-performed work in developing markets. Cyclical, weather-exposed, no pricing power.

Recent Trend

Revenue exploding via acquisition (+114% YoY in Q2) but quality deteriorating: adj EBITDA margin collapsed 18.6% to 12.4%, GAAP gross margin printed 10.8%, EPS of $0.26 missed consensus of about $0.47, net income fell 35%, and the stock fell 36.2% in the August 11 session and 84% from its high. Seven insiders bought 221,597 shares for about $8.5M on August 14-17 at $36.26 to $40.12. Growth without profit, with securities investigations now open.

Forward Growth

Guided revenue of $880-900M with ALGC, plus SE infrastructure tailwinds and a self-performing model. Backlog of $866M is a record in dollars but growth slowed to +35% YoY from +60% in Q1. Hughes Brothers would add $220M of TTM revenue at a 25.0% adjusted EBITDA margin if it closes in Q4 2026. The margin guide was cut, integration is unproven, and civil construction is cyclical.

Valuation

DCF base $50.90 vs spot $13.80 implies 269% upside. Forward P/E 4.5x and NTM EV/EBITDA 3.5x are distressed multiples. Reverse DCF prices -20.2% revenue CAGR, below the 6.0% bear case: the market prices contraction.

Cascadia scorecard

Composite score 54: Fair. Confidence Medium, as of 23-Oct-2026.

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PILLAR	RATIONALE	SCORE
Operating Quality	Small-cap civil/infrastructure contractor with thin moat (competitive bidding), 21% gross and 8.8% operating margins on FY2025, and a net cash position of $142M at June 30, 2026. Q2 2026 gross margin printed 10.8% as subcontracted labor and equipment rentals replaced self-performed work in developing markets. Cyclical, weather-exposed, no pricing power.	40
Recent Trend	Revenue exploding via acquisition (+114% YoY in Q2) but quality deteriorating: adj EBITDA margin collapsed 18.6% to 12.4%, GAAP gross margin printed 10.8%, EPS of $0.26 missed consensus of about $0.47, net income fell 35%, and the stock fell 36.2% in the August 11 session and 84% from its high. Seven insiders bought 221,597 shares for about $8.5M on August 14-17 at $36.26 to $40.12. Growth without profit, with securities investigations now open.	50
Forward Growth	Guided revenue of $880-900M with ALGC, plus SE infrastructure tailwinds and a self-performing model. Backlog of $866M is a record in dollars but growth slowed to +35% YoY from +60% in Q1. Hughes Brothers would add $220M of TTM revenue at a 25.0% adjusted EBITDA margin if it closes in Q4 2026. The margin guide was cut, integration is unproven, and civil construction is cyclical.	55
Valuation	DCF base $50.90 vs spot $13.80 implies 269% upside. Forward P/E 4.5x and NTM EV/EBITDA 3.5x are distressed multiples. Reverse DCF prices -20.2% revenue CAGR, below the 6.0% bear case: the market prices contraction.	72
Catalysts & Risk	Q3 margin recovery is the make-or-break catalyst, and the Hughes Brothers close in Q4 2026 adds 5,255,420 shares plus an earnout of up to $162.5M. Risks dominate: execution risk on a small-cap base, ALGC integration, securities investigations announced by three firms in September and October, cyclical SE construction exposure, thin analyst coverage. Negatively skewed until margins stabilize.	45

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Investment view

Q3 margin trajectory is the swing factor: sustained adjusted EBITDA recovery toward the guided range would validate the bull case and the base case at $50.90. The Hughes Brothers close, the earnout it eventually carries, and the litigation path decide how much of any recovery reaches current shareholders. Further erosion, or debt stress, would confirm the market's -20.2% implied contraction.

Investment view: Buy. The $52.70 blended target implies +282%, balancing the $40.00 / $50.90 / $69.00 Bear / Base / Bull outcomes.

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